POL 101: INTRODUCTION TO POLITICAL SCIENCE
Section 20 - FINAL - Summer 2026
Instructor: Dr. Hassan Afzal (hassan.afzal@bracu.ac.bd)
Comparing Political Regimes: Democracy, Development, State Power, and Political Competition

Each team will prepare a short analytical script, complete an individual team check, and then produce one Collective Multimedia Project(30%). The work should be properly formatted, edited, cited, and clearly divided among team members. Each team will compare the same four countries: **Uruguay, Ghana, Singapore, and Tunisia.** The set is designed to support careful comparison across democratic accountability, backsliding, deepening, political competition, development, state capacity, and political change.

Project Sequence

The project follows one clear order: Script -> Individual Team Checking -> Final Video. The purpose is to make the script the analytical foundation, use the checking to verify individual understanding, and record the video only after that check.

Stage (Weight within Final Examination**)**	**What happens**
1. Team Script - 40%	Submit the final team script through Turnitin by the deadline. Everyone submits their team script. The submitted script becomes the basis for individual checking. (Due: **Monday August 31st 11.59 PM on Turnitin**)
2. Individual Team Checking (ITC) - 30%	After the Turnitin submission, each student is checked individually within the team. (**Wednesday, September 2nd in-class**)
3. Collective Video Essay - 30%	Only after the individual check, the team records and submits one 10–15-minute video essay. File size must be less than 1 GB. (**Monday September 7th, 2026**)

Important: The final examination is worth 30% of the course grade. The Team Script, ITC, and Multimedia Project therefore contribute 12%, 9%, and 9% of the course grade, respectively.

Main Question

How do Uruguay, Ghana, Singapore, and Tunisia help us explain variation in democratic accountability, political competition, development, and state power using post-midterm POL 101 readings and evidence? Use FIW scores and/or V-Dem's LDI for the latest five available years to support your comparison.

The Team Script

The team script should be around 1300-1700 words. Some reasonable flexibility is allowed, but the script should be focused, edited, and analytically. It should **not be a** collection of four separate country summaries. The script must include the following:

1) A dedicated cover page, then starts with a clear introduction that names the four countries and states one main comparative argument.

2) Discuss each country briefly, then compare similarities and differences directly rather than presenting four isolated reports. Make sure it is a conversation between team members.
3) Use at least three post midterm readings. Some countries may need different reading(s) than others. Apply their concepts to the evidence rather than merely mentioning the authors.
4) Use FIW scores and/or V-Dem's LDI for the latest five available years to support your comparison, plus at least one credible news or institutional source where needed.
5) Include one brief alternative explanation, limitation, or claim boundary so the conclusion does not go beyond the evidence.
6) Use in-text citations, include a reference list, and **finish with the role table showing each** student's contribution at the end of the script.

Team Roles

Each Summer 2026 team has five members. Four students should lead one country each, and the fifth student should lead the comparison and help connect the readings across the four cases. All five members must contribute to the script and speak in the final video essay.

Suggested roles: Uruguay lead, Ghana lead, Singapore lead, Tunisia lead, and Team Analyst / Comparison lead.

Team List

Team 1: Muzadded Rahman; Ahnaf Sharar Rhine; Sajid Ahmed; Tamzid Nawfel; Marzia Tabassum
Team 2: Tasfiha Tanveen; Bushra Tasnim; Kazi Rayeed Asif; Hasin Shadab; Muhtady Mahmud
Team 3: Marian Baroi; Tassuba Ahmed; Ahmed Arsalan Nafis; Afnan Mohammad Hafiz; Mashrafi Islam Alif
Team 4: Nafis Uddin Chowdhury; Riddho Nirupom Mondal; Mashrafi Azad Saad; Maliha Zannat. Mysha Alam Diya
Team 5: Md. Redwan Hoque Siddique; Ambrose Kabbo Dhali; Ahmed Rawnak Ishrak Bhuban; Tayassuk Md Abir; Rakibul Hasan Shihab
Team 6: Lamia Tarek; Ekhlasul Hossain Adib; Kazi Jubaer Faruk; Namira Shehrin; Dia Nur Sehba
Team 7: Ramisa Tabassum Arpa; Bushra Habib; Sadnan Basher; Md. Abu Zubayer; Mubtasin Fuad

Dos and Don'ts:

Use course readings clearly and accurately. Compare all four countries. Cite all factual claims and statistics. Ensure each student has a visible and meaningful role. Speak in your own voice and use a respectful academic tone.

Do not submit a general country report without course concepts. Do not rank the countries as simply "best" or "worst." Do not use uncited claims. Do not let one or two students complete the whole project. Do not record the final video before the individual team checking. Do not use AI-generated voiceovers. Do not submit copied, unedited, or careless work.

General Instructions

Font: Times New Roman, 12-point. Spacing: 1.5. Citation style: APA 7th edition. In-text citations are required. A reference list is required at the end of the script. Sources should include course readings, V-Dem, Freedom House, and credible news or institutional sources.

Submission: All team members submit the team script through Turnitin. Individual team checking takes place after submission. After checking, one team member uploads the final collective video essay to the assigned Google Classroom/shared Drive link.

AI policy: AI-generated work will not be accepted as a substitute for original student work. AI-generated voiceovers are not allowed.

Late work: Due to the nature of the final examination and schedules, no late work will be accepted unless an exception is approved under university policy. Please communicate as early as possible in a documented emergency.

Final Collective Video Essay

The final video essay should be 10-15 minutes and less than 1 GB. It is one collective team submission, not five separate videos. Each member must contribute meaningfully and speak. The video should follow the submitted and checked script and clearly connect country evidence with course concepts. Visuals may be used where they help the argument, but analytical clarity and evidence remain the priority.

Role Table Required at the End of the Script

Student name	Country or role	Main contribution
	Team Representative	
	Ghana lead	
	Singapore lead	
	Tunisia lead	
	Uruguay lead	

Grading Breakdown

Component	Course Weight
Team Script: 1. Comparative argument and structure — 30% 2. Application of course readings and concepts — 30% 3. Comparative evidence, including FIW/LDI — 30% 4. Role and contribution table — 10%	40%
Individual Team Checking (ITC): 1. Individual readiness and assigned role (30%) 2. Course concept, evidence (30%) 3. Comparison and limitation (40%)	30%
Collective Video Essay 1. 10-15 minutes, collaborative team effort (20%) 2. Meaningfully incorporated ITC Feedback (20%) 3. Integration of evidence with course concepts (40%) 4. A clear conclusion and key takeaways shared (20%)	30%
Total Final Examination	**100%**